25900690 **MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**

MGU-UGP (Honours) Regular Examination, October, 2025

Third Semester

Value Added Course (VAC) – MG3VACZGY200

Science of Happiness and Human Rights

(2024 Admission onwards)

Duration : 1Hr 30minutes **Max. Marks: 50**

PART – A

Multiple Choice Questions – Each Question carries 1 mark (Answer all questions)

1. How many independent experts serve on the Human Rights Committee? **CO4**

Ans: a. 10

2. …….is a way of rewiring brains to be happy **CO2**

Ans: b. Fostering Healthy relationships

3. A student argue that since 50% of happiness is genetically set. Interventions are useless. Which critique best addresses this misunderstanding? **CO1**

Ans: b. Genetics only determines baseline happiness, but intentional activities (~40%) can significantly raise well-being.

4. Which among the following is NOT a linguistic minority language in Kerala? **CO4**

Ans : a. Malayalis

5. Absenteeism at work due to stress is an example of which type of response? **CO3**

Ans :b. Behavioural response

6. Which of the following is NOT a treaty-based body? **CO4**

Ans :c. Human Rights Council

7. In the countershock phase of the alarm stage, what physiological response is triggered? **CO3**

Ans :c. Fight-or-flight response

8. Which among the following is not part of happiness chemicals? **CO1**

Ans: d. vasopressin

9. The historical document that limited the power of the English monarchy and established certain legal rights in 1215? **CO4**

Ans : a. Magna Carta

10. The Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination (CERD) monitors the implementation of which treaty? **CO4**

Ans : c. ICERD

11. Which of the following is recognized as a key indicator in the World Happiness Report? **CO2**

Ans: b. GDP per capita

12. What is the primary goal of biofeedback in stress management? **CO3**

Ans: c. To gain control over involuntary physiological functions

PART – B

Short Answer – Any 6 questions – Each question carries 3 marks

13. List out the major International human rights documents. **CO4**

1. UDHR, ICCPR, ICESCR, - International Bill of Human Rights
2. Convention Relating to the Status of Refugees, 1951
3. Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women, 1979
4. Convention on the Rights of the Child, 1989. ***(Each point -0.75mark)***

14. Identify the limitations of Human rights commission. **CO4**

1. Their recommendations are not binding,
2. They lack independent investigative powers relying mostly on government agencies,
3. They have limited jurisdiction over private parties ***(Each point -1 mark)***

15. Discuss cultural and educational rights in Indian constitution. **CO4**

Cultural and Educational Rights, under Articles 29 and 30, protect the interests of cultural, linguistic, and religious minorities.

Article 29: any group of citizens can preserve their language, script, or culture, and no citizen can be denied admission to educational institutions on grounds of religion, race, caste, or language.

Article 30: gives minorities the right to establish and manage their own educational institutions. ***(Each point -1.5 mark)***

16. What strategies can enhance physical, emotional, & psychological well-being for greater happiness? **CO1**

Strategies include **1)** maintaining a healthy lifestyle (balanced diet, exercise, sleep), **2)** practicing emotional intelligence (self-awareness, empathy, stress management), and **3)** nurturing psychological growth (goal-setting, mindfulness, cultivating meaning). By addressing all three dimensions, individuals can achieve balanced and lasting happiness. ***(Each strategy - 1 mark)***

17. Why is it important to review your task list at the end of the day? **CO3**

It helps to evaluate what was accomplished, adjust priorities, carry over unfinished tasks, and improve planning for the next day. ***(3 points-1 mark each)***

18. Comment on Human ecology. **CO1**

It is the interdisciplinary study of how humans interact with their environments, encompassing the biophysical, social, and cultural aspects of these relationships across various spatial and temporal scales. It examines the factors that shape human-environment interactions, drawing from natural and social sciences, to understand issues like sustainability, environmental justice, public health, and human adaptation to diverse ecosystems. ***(3 points- 1 mark each)***

19. Explain Genetic/ Personality theories of happiness and find out the key aspect of it. **CO2**

It proposes that happiness is influenced by our genes and associated with the personality traits of individual. Personality traits are stable patterns of thoughts, feelings, and actions that distinguish people as individuals. ***(2 points - 1.5 marks each)***

20. List three ways in which positive stress contributes to adaptation and performance. **CO3**

Positive stress helps by: • Acting as a motivator to perform tasks. • Enabling adaptation to environmental demands. • Improving biopsychosocial health and performance. ***(Each point- 1 mark)***

PART – C

Short Essay Questions – Answer any 4 questions – Each question carries 5 marks.

21. Explain how concept of happiness is understood and experienced in different cross-cultural contexts. **CO2**

- **Individualistic cultures**, happiness is often linked to personal achievement, independence, and freedom of choice. People feel happy when they succeed in their goals, gain recognition, and have control over their lives. These cultures encourage self-expression, confidence, and innovation, making happiness more individual-centered.

- **Collectivist cultures**, happiness is tied to community, relationships, and social harmony. Here, people experience joy by supporting one another, fulfilling group responsibilities, and maintaining close family or social bonds. Happiness in this context grows from belongingness, cooperation, and emotional security. **(Explanation of each point-2.5 marks)**

22. Describe First, Second and Third generations of Human rights with examples. **CO4**

1. First Generation: Civil and Political Rights (Liberty-Oriented) Concept: These are "negative" rights, meaning they require the state to refrain from interfering in an individual's liberties. They are focused on freedom from state oppression. **Core Examples:** Right to Life, Liberty, and Security, Freedom of Speech and expression, Freedom of Religion and conscience, Freedom from Torture, slavery, and arbitrary arrest, Right to Vote and participate in government

2. Second Generation: Economic, Social, and Cultural Rights (Equality-Oriented) Concept: These are "positive" rights, meaning they require the state to actively intervene and provide resources, services, and conditions to ensure a life of dignity. They are focused on freedom to thrive. **Core Examples:** Right to Work and fair wages, Right to Education, Right to Healthcare, Right to Social Security and an adequate standard of living (food, clothing, housing), Right to Form and Join Trade Unions, Right to Participate in Cultural Life

3. Third Generation: Solidarity Rights (Fraternity-Oriented) Concept: These are "collective" rights that belong to groups, peoples, and societies as a whole. They emphasize global cooperation and solidarity to address complex, transnational challenges. **Core Examples**: Right to Self-Determination (for peoples under colonial rule or foreign occupation), Right to Economic and Social Development, Right to a Healthy and Sustainable Environment, Right to Peace, Right to Benefit from the Common Heritage of Mankind (e.g., cultural heritage, scientific advances). ***(Description of 3 points -3 marks, 2 examples of each point-2marks)***

23. In what ways does regular physical exercise improve mental focus and emotional well-being? **CO1**

1. Boosts brain function: Exercise increases blood flow to the brain, enhancing concentration, memory, and mental clarity
2. Reduces stress and anxiety: Physical activity lowers stress hormones and increases endorphins, improving mood and emotional balance
3. Improves sleep: Better sleep quality leads to sharper focus and more stable emotions in the day
4. Increases self-confidence and motivation: Achieving fitness goals can boost self-esteem, leading to a more positive mindset
5. Enhances energy levels: More energy supports sustained attention and emotional resilience throughout the day. ***(Each point with description- 1 mark each)***

24. Explain the importance of the principle of Indivisibility and Interdependence of human rights. **CO4**

It means that all human rights—civil, political, economic, social, and cultural—are equally essential and cannot be separated from one another. For example, the right to life is closely linked to the right to food, clean water, and healthcare. Without access to these, the right to life cannot be fully enjoyed.The indivisibility of rights asserts that no right is more important than another, and nations cannot choose to respect some rights while ignoring others. The interdependence of rights emphasizes that progress in one area supports progress in others. This principle is important because it prevents governments from selectively upholding certain rights while neglecting others, which could lead to inequality and injustice. ***(Any Relevant points give full marks)***

25. Contrast personal and organizational sources of stress, highlighting their different impacts. **CO2**

Personal stressors: Relationship issues, major life changes, health problems, financial struggles, parenting, and perfectionism primarily affect emotional well-being and family life.

Organizational stressors: Workload, lack of autonomy, workplace changes, and poor relationships at work mainly affect job performance, satisfaction, and professional stability**.** ***(Each point with explanation - 2.5marks)***

26. Discuss the application of Maslow's hierarchy in education **CO1**

Maslow's hierarchy of needs can be applied in education by ensuring students' basic needs for physiological well-being and safety are met before they can engage with higher-level learning needs like belongingness, esteem, and self-actualization. Educators can support these needs by providing a safe, inclusive classroom, offering nutritious snacks, and building positive relationships to create an environment where students feel secure and valued, enabling them to focus on academic achievement and reach their full potential. ***(Explanation of each level- 1 mark: no need to draw pyramid)***

